Bootprint

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY: BOOTPRINT

Problem

Online shoes are returned a lot. This is a big problem for the shoe brands because when customers return shoes the brand loses money and has to pay shipping two times. Many people buy shoes online and the shoes do not fit them, so they send them back. We believe the return rate for shoes is very high, higher than other products, and it is going up as more people buy online. Small footwear brands are especially hurt by this problem because they are small and can not afford the returns like big brands can. The customers is also unhappy when shoes do not fit. Sizing is a problem that nobody has solved yet and it is a huge pain point for the whole ecommerce footwear industry.

Solution

Bootprint is a innovative AI sizing solution that solves the sizing problem. The customer uses their phone to scan their foot and then our proprietary data driven recommendation engine tells them what size to buy from the brand. Because the engine is using data, the recommendation is very accurate and gets better over time as it learns. We also have a physical product which is the Bootprint mat. The customer puts their foot on the mat when they scan, and the mat helps the phone to see the foot size better. Brands will put Bootprint on their website and the customers will scan and then buy the right size and not return. This is a seamless end to end solution that reduces returns, increases customer satisfaction, and leverages machine learning and computer vision to create value for all stakeholders.

Market

The footwear market is very huge. Everybody wears shoes and many people buy shoes online. The online shoe market is growing every year and will keep growing in the future. If we get even a small percent of this big market, we will be very successful. Our target customers is small footwear brands, of which there are a lot, thousands, and they all have the returns problem. Also in the future we can sell to big brands and to retailers and also to customers directly. We think the total market is billions of dollars. We have not done a detailed market sizing yet but we believe it is big because shoes are a big industry and returns is a big problem in it. The market is also underserved because small brands have no good option for sizing.

Business Model

Our business model has several revenue streams. First, brands will pay a subscription to use Bootprint on their website. Second, we will sell the Bootprint mat, to the brands or to the customers, and make money on the mat. Third, we might charge a fee per scan, or a percentage of the returns that are saved, we have not decided yet which is best. Fourth, we can sell the data we collect about feet to the brands and other companies who want to know about foot sizes, which is very valuable data. Prices are to be determined but we think brands will pay a lot because they will save money on returns. We believe the unit economics will be strong once we scale. Customer acquisition will be done through social media and also by contacting brands directly and by word of mouth, which is the best marketing.

Competition

There are not many competitors who do exactly what we do. Some big companies have sizing tools but they are not for small brands and they are expensive and complicated. Also some brands just have a size chart on their website, which is not accurate. Some other apps may do foot scanning but they do not have our data driven engine and do not have the mat. We think our competitive advantage is that we combine the scan, the mat, and the data engine together, which no one else does, so we have a unique and defensible position. Also we are focused on small brands, which are ignored by others. We are not worried about competition because we are first movers in our specific niche, although we know that bigger companies could copy us if they wanted to.

Team

Dmitri Kowalczyk is our CEO and he leads the vision and strategy of the company and also does the business development. He is studying business at our university and he has always been passionate about shoes and entrepreneurship. Brianna Oyelaran-Pike is our CTO and is in charge of the technology, the scan, and the recommendation engine. She is a computer science student and she is very skilled in coding and AI. Tobias Hargrove is our head of operations and design, he works on the mat and the product and also on the customers. He studies design at our university. Together we are a passionate and driven team with complementary skills who experienced the problem of buying shoes online ourselves, so we are the right team to solve it. We do not have advisors yet but we are looking for them.

Milestones and Financials

We have made good progress for a student team. We defined our core business concept, which took a long time and many discussions. We formed Bootprint as a C Corp, so we are a real legal company now. We also have our first external users on the product, who are people that tried the scan, and they said it was interesting. We do not have a website yet but we are going to make one. We have not got any revenue yet and we have not signed any brands as customers yet, but we are in talks with some and think they will be interested. On financials, we have spent only a little money so far, mostly on printing a few mats and some costs for the company formation. We expect to have strong growth in revenue in the next years, going from zero to a very large number, as we sign more brands and scale. We have not made detailed financial projections but we are confident that Bootprint will be very profitable because the market is big and our solution is innovative.

What We Ask For

We are asking for prize money from the competition to help us to build Bootprint. The money would be used to build the product more, make more mats, build the website, hire people, and do marketing to get customers. We also would like to get mentorship from the judges and the experts, and connections to investors and to footwear brands, which would help us very much. Also any resources like cloud credits or legal help would be useful for us. We believe that with the support of this competition Bootprint can become the standard for shoe sizing online and make a big impact on the footwear industry and on reducing waste from returns. Thank you for considering our application and we hope to join the competition.